A LEAN-VERIFIED SAME-HEIGHT FIBER FRAMEWORK FOR THE RIEMANN HYPOTHESIS

BISWAJIT MONDAL

Abstract. The Riemann Hypothesis asserts that every nontrivial zero of the Riemann zeta function has real part 1/2. This manuscript reports a formal reduction program, implemented and checked in Lean, which reorganizes the problem around the geometry of zero fibers at fixed imaginary height. The central verified equivalence is that RH is equivalent to the assertion that no two critical-strip zeros with the same imaginary part have different real parts. We further formalize energy, cardinality, zero-free-threshold, de la Vallee Poussin 3-4-1, and horizontal critical-point criteria that make this same-height obstruction precise.

The contribution is not a proof of RH. Rather, it is a proof-checked architecture for isolating the exact remaining analytic input: a same-height repulsion or uniqueness principle for zeta zeros. The Lean development contains no active uses of `sorry`, `admit`, or local axioms in the verified surface. We also record a negative result from numerical experimentation: global strict midpoint convexity of $x \mapsto |\zeta(x + i\gamma)|^2$ on the critical strip is too strong and is contradicted already at small height. The framework therefore narrows the next viable target to local horizontal curve/argument-principle constraints rather than global convexity.

1. Introduction

Riemann's 1859 memoir connected the distribution of primes with the zeros of the analytically continued zeta function and formulated what is now called the Riemann Hypothesis [Rie59]. In modern notation, the nontrivial zeros are those in the critical strip

$$\mathcal{S} = \{s \in \mathbb{C} : 0 < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1\},$$

and RH asserts that every such zero satisfies $\mathrm{Re}(s) = 1/2$. The problem has been attacked through zero-free regions, explicit formulae, positivity criteria, spectral interpretations, random matrix statistics, and rigorous computation; see, for example, Titchmarsh and Heath-Brown [THB86], Edwards [Edw74], Iwaniec and Kowalski [IK04], the DLMF survey [NIS26], and recent formalization work in Lean [LS25].

This paper describes a complementary proof-search framework. Instead of trying to estimate the entire critical strip directly, we organize possible

Date: October 17, 2026.

counterexamples by their imaginary height. For each $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}$, let

$$\mathcal{F}_\gamma = \{s \in \mathbb{C} : \zeta(s) = 0,\ 0 < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1,\ \mathrm{Im}(s) = \gamma\}.$$

The key observation is elementary once the usual zeta symmetries are available: an off-line zero forces a second zero at the same height, reflected across the critical line. Consequently, RH is equivalent to real-coordinate uniqueness in every fixed-height zero fiber. The value of this reformulation is not that it makes RH easier for free. The value is that it makes the missing analytic ingredient exact: rule out same-height collisions.

Contributions. The verified development makes the following contributions.

(i) It gives Lean-checked equivalences between RH and same-height zero uniqueness, no-collision formulations, and fiberwise real-coordinate uniqueness.
(ii) It defines a finite fiber energy and verifies that vanishing of this energy at every height is equivalent to RH.
(iii) It proves that a cardinality bound $|\mathcal{F}_\gamma| \le 1$ for every γ is sufficient for RH, using formalized conjugate symmetry and centroid identities.
(iv) It records a zero-free-threshold equivalence: RH is equivalent to zero-freeness to the right of every vertical line $\mathrm{Re}(s) = b$ with $b > 1/2$.
(v) It formalizes a de la Vallee Poussin 3-4-1 Euler-product bridge in the half-plane $\sigma > 1$, including the lower bound

$$|\zeta(\sigma)^3\zeta(\sigma + it)^4\zeta(\sigma + 2it)| \ge 1.$$

(vi) It tests and rejects a natural global convexity route, then replaces it by sharper conditional horizontal critical-point criteria.

All statements above refer to the currently checked Lean files in the `Reinmann/` directory. The project intentionally distinguishes verified Lean modules from research notes and numerical experiments.

Status of the result. This manuscript should not be read as a claimed solution of RH. The remaining gap is the following analytic principle.

> *Same-height repulsion problem.* Prove that two distinct zeros of $\zeta(s)$ in the open critical strip cannot have the same imaginary part.

The formal development proves that this principle is exactly strong enough to settle RH. It does not prove the principle.

2. Literature review and novelty

2.1. **Classical zero-free methods.** The classical proof of the prime number theorem by Hadamard and de la Vallee Poussin established, among other things, nonvanishing on the line $\mathrm{Re}(s) = 1$. The DLMF records this boundary zero-free result and the standard symmetries of the critical strip [NIS26]. This line of work developed into explicit zero-free regions and bounds for

$\zeta(s)$, as systematized in Titchmarsh–Heath-Brown [THB86] and later analytic number theory texts [IK04].

Our work uses the classical boundary line as a formal component, but it does not try to improve explicit zero-free regions. The zero-free-threshold theorem in Section 5 instead records a logical equivalence: if all vertical strips $\mathrm{Re}(s) > b$, $b > 1/2$, are zero-free inside the critical strip, then RH follows, and conversely RH gives these zero-free statements.

2.2. **Equivalent positivity criteria.** Several well-known criteria re-express RH as a positivity assertion. Weil's explicit formula gives positivity criteria for test functions [Wei52]. Li's criterion states that RH is equivalent to nonnegativity of a sequence of coefficients derived from the xi function [Li97], and Bombieri–Lagarias generalized this viewpoint [BL99]. These criteria are close in spirit to the present work because they replace the location statement by another global assertion whose failure detects an off-line zero.

The difference is the granularity of the obstruction. Li and Weil criteria aggregate over all zeros. The present energy criterion is fiberwise: each imaginary height γ receives an energy measuring the squared distance of zeros in $\mathcal{F}_\gamma$ from the critical line. RH is equivalent to the vanishing of this entire family of local energies.

2.3. **Spectral and physical approaches.** The Hilbert–Polya idea asks for a self-adjoint operator whose spectrum encodes the imaginary parts of zeta zeros. Berry and Keating related the smooth zero counting law to quantizations of $H = xp$ [BK99]; Connes interpreted critical zeros as an absorption spectrum in a noncommutative geometric trace formula [Con99]. These programs are deep and structural, but a complete RH proof would still need a mechanism forcing critical-line location.

The same-height framework is compatible with spectral intuition but does not postulate an operator. It isolates a simpler spectral-looking obstruction: degeneracy of the imaginary height map on the set of strip zeros. A Hilbert–Polya proof would imply such nondegeneracy after identifying the correct self-adjoint model, but the present framework leaves the analytic source of the repulsion open.

2.4. **Random matrix statistics and simplicity.** Montgomery's pair-correlation program and Odlyzko's computations connect local zero statistics with eigenvalues of random Hermitian matrices [Mon73, Odl87]. Recent work has continued to sharpen what can be proved about pair correlation and simple zeros; for instance, Baluyot–Goldston–Suriajaya–Turnage-Butterbaugh prove an unconditional Montgomery-type theorem with a conditional application to the proportion of simple zeros in a thin box near the critical line [BGSTB24].

These results concern vertical spacings and multiplicity. Same-height uniqueness is a different obstruction. A multiple zero on the critical line is not automatically a same-height collision with different real parts, and a

same-height off-line pair could consist of two simple zeros. Thus the present formulation is not subsumed by the usual simplicity conjecture, although both are zero-repulsion statements.

2.5. **Rigorous computation and formal proof.** Rigorous numerical methods have verified RH up to finite heights; Platt isolated nontrivial zeros up to height 30,610,046,000 with rigorous error bounds [Pla17]. Formal proof assistants address a different problem: they remove ambiguity from symbolic arguments. The Lean mathematical library provides the foundation used here [The20], and recent work formalizes zeta and Dirichlet L-functions, including a formal statement of RH [LS25].

The novelty of this paper lies at the intersection of these directions: proof-checked reductions, expressed in Lean, that turn RH into a precise same-height uniqueness target. The contribution is not a new numerical verification range and not a new zero-free region; it is a verified logical spine for future analytic work.

3. Formal setup

We use the Riemann zeta function $\zeta(s)$, meromorphically continued to $\mathbb{C}$, and let RH denote the standard statement that all nontrivial zeros lie on the line $\mathrm{Re}(s) = 1/2$. The Lean development imports mathlib's `RiemannHypothesis : Prop`; local modules then prove reductions to this formal target.

Definition 3.1 (Critical-strip fiber)**.** *For $\gamma \in \mathbb{R}$, define*

$$\mathcal{F}_\gamma = \{s \in \mathbb{C} : \zeta(s) = 0,\ 0 < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1,\ \mathrm{Im}(s) = \gamma\}.$$

Definition 3.2 (Fiber uniqueness)**.** *The zero-fiber uniqueness property is*

$$\forall \gamma \in \mathbb{R}, \quad \forall s, t \in \mathcal{F}_\gamma, \quad \mathrm{Re}(s) = \mathrm{Re}(t).$$

Equivalently, no two critical-strip zeros of ζ have the same imaginary part and different real parts.

Definition 3.3 (Fiber energy)**.** *For a finite fiber, define*

$$E(\gamma) = \sum_{s \in \mathcal{F}_\gamma} (\mathrm{Re}(s) - 1/2)^2.$$

The Lean implementation uses a finite set representation supplied by the local zero-finiteness module.

Remark 3.4. *The finiteness of each fiber is not an RH assumption. It follows from isolation of zeros of a nonzero analytic function in the relevant bounded horizontal slice; in the repository this is encapsulated by the module `ZeroFiberFiniteness.lean`.*

4. Verified main reductions

Figure 1 illustrates the objects of this section.

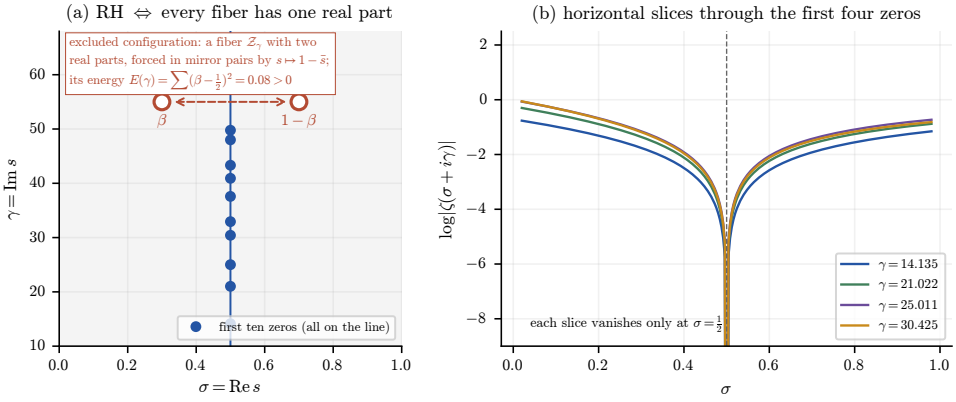


FIGURE 1. Same-height fibers. (a) The first ten nontrivial zeros, all on $\mathrm{Re}\, s = \frac{1}{2}$, so each nonempty fiber is a single point. The red pair is the configuration that Theorem 4.1 shows to be exactly what RH excludes: an off-line zero at height γ forces its mirror image at the same height, giving a fiber with two real parts and positive energy $E(\gamma)$ (Theorem 4.3). (b) Horizontal slices $\sigma \mapsto \log|\zeta(\sigma + i\gamma)|$, $0.02 \le \sigma \le 0.98$, at the first four zero heights, computed with mpmath; each vanishes only at $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$. The plot illustrates known data and is not evidence for heights beyond those shown.

4.1. **Same-height uniqueness.**

Theorem 4.1 (Fiber uniqueness criterion)**.** *RH is equivalent to zero-fiber real-coordinate uniqueness at every imaginary height.*

Lean status. This is formalized by

`riemannHypothesis_iff_forall_zeroFiberRealUnique_unconditional`

in `RiemannHypothesisReduction.lean`. Earlier versions treated strip conjugation as an obligation; the current development closes this bridge using the conjugation-symmetry module. □

Remark 4.2. *The theorem explains why the same-height target is not a weakening of RH. It is an equivalent form. Any proposed proof of same-height uniqueness therefore needs analytic strength comparable to a proof of RH.*

4.2. **Energy criterion.**

Theorem 4.3 (Fiber-energy criterion)**.** *RH is equivalent to*

$$\forall \gamma \in \mathbb{R}, \quad E(\gamma) = 0.$$

Lean status. This is formalized as

`riemannHypothesis_iff_forall_fiberEnergy_zero`

in `SpectralEnergyCriterion.lean`. The proof uses nonnegativity of each summand and the fact that the squared real displacement vanishes exactly on the critical line. □

Corollary 4.4 (Positive energy detects RH failure)**.** *RH fails if and only if some height has positive fiber energy.*

Lean status. This is formalized as

`not_riemannHypothesis_iff_exists_fiberEnergy_pos`

in `FiberEnergyGap.lean`. □

4.3. **Centroid and cardinality.** Conjugate/functional-equation symmetries force off-line zeros to occur in mirror pairs across $\mathrm{Re}(s) = 1/2$. This gives a useful centroid identity.

Theorem 4.5 (Fiber centroid)**.** *If $\mathcal{F}_\gamma$ is nonempty, then the average of the real parts of its zeros is* $1/2$*.*

Lean status. The finite-sum identity is formalized by

`fiber_centroid_eq_half`

in `FiberCentroid.lean`. □

Corollary 4.6 (Cardinality sufficient condition)**.** *If $|\mathcal{F}_\gamma| \le 1$ for every γ, then RH holds.*

Lean status. The proof is formalized by

`riemannHypothesis_of_all_fiber_card_le_one`

in `FiberCentroid.lean`. A one-point fiber has centroid $1/2$, so its only point lies on the critical line; empty fibers contribute nothing. □

5. Zero-free and de la Vallee Poussin bridges

5.1. **Vertical threshold formulation.**

Definition 5.1. *For $b \in \mathbb{R}$, let* ZeroFreeRightOf(b) *denote the assertion that no critical-strip zero satisfies* $\mathrm{Re}(s) > b$*.*

Theorem 5.2 (Threshold criterion)**.** *RH is equivalent to*

$$\forall b > 1/2, \quad \text{ZeroFreeRightOf}(b).$$

Lean status. This is formalized by

`riemannHypothesis_iff_zeroFreeRightOf_all_gt_half`

in `ZeroFreeEngine.lean`. □

5.2. **The 3-4-1 product.** The de la Vallee Poussin boundary-line proof uses the elementary trigonometric positivity

$$3 + 4\cos\theta + \cos(2\theta) = 2(1 + \cos\theta)^2 \geq 0.$$

In the half-plane $\sigma > 1$, this positivity yields an Euler-product lower bound.

Theorem 5.3 (3-4-1 zeta product)**.** *For $\sigma > 1$ and $t \in \mathbb{R}$,*

$$\left|\zeta(\sigma)^3\zeta(\sigma + it)^4\zeta(\sigma + 2it)\right| \geq 1.$$

Lean status. The trigonometric component is formalized in `ZeroFreeEngine.lean`. The Euler-product bridge and the zeta-specialized product bound are formalized by

`zeta_341_modulus`

in `Zeta341GlobalBridge.lean`. The conditional limit contradiction against a boundary zero is recorded in `VdpConditional.lean`. □

Remark 5.4. *This component is a verified bridge, not a new proof of the classical boundary zero-free theorem. Mathlib already supplies the boundary nonvanishing fact needed by the active Lean development.*

6. Horizontal repulsion experiments

The same-height formulation suggests a horizontal repulsion principle: for fixed γ, the function $x \mapsto \zeta(x + i\gamma)$ should be unable to hit zero twice in $0 < x < 1$. We formalized two classes of sufficient conditions.

6.1. **A failed convexity target.** A natural first target was strict midpoint convexity of

$$x \mapsto |\zeta(x + i\gamma)|^2$$

on the critical strip. Lean verifies that this global property would imply RH:

`riemannHypothesis_of_horizontalStrictMidpointConvex`.

However, numerical testing falsifies the proposed global convexity. With $\gamma = 0.5$, $x = 0.66$, $y = 0.98$, and $m = 0.82$, high-precision evaluation gives

$$|\zeta(m + i\gamma)|^2 \approx 3.0092902087845057592,$$

whereas

$$\frac{|\zeta(x + i\gamma)|^2 + |\zeta(y + i\gamma)|^2}{2} \approx 2.9997768238141877056.$$

Thus the midpoint value is larger than the endpoint average. The convexity route is therefore too strong. Figure 2 shows the failure: on $[0.66, 0.98]$ the slice rises above its chord on a whole subinterval, which no convex function can do.

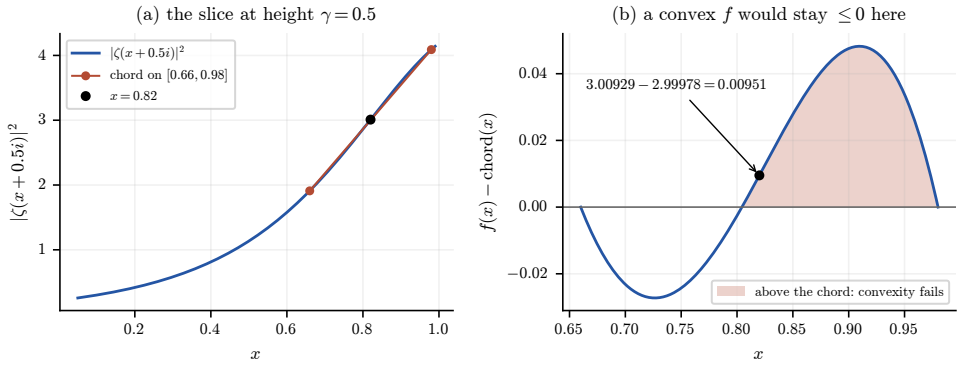


FIGURE 2. The falsified global convexity target at $\gamma = 0.5$, computed with mpmath. (a) $f(x) = |\zeta(x + 0.5i)|^2$ and its chord on $[0.66, 0.98]$. (b) The difference $f(x) - \mathrm{chord}(x)$; a convex function would keep it ≤ 0. It is positive on roughly $[0.81, 0.98)$, including the reported midpoint $x = 0.82$.

6.2. **Horizontal critical-point criteria.** The failed convexity experiment motivates a local alternative. If a real-valued differentiable function vanishes at two points, Rolle's theorem forces a critical point between them. For the complex-valued horizontal slice

$$f_\gamma(x) = \zeta(x + i\gamma),$$

one should apply this idea componentwise to $\mathrm{Re}\, f_\gamma$ and $\mathrm{Im}\, f_\gamma$. The Lean development therefore formalizes a conditional criterion: if two distinct same-height zeros forced a forbidden pair of componentwise critical points between them, then every fiber has cardinality at most one, and RH follows.

Theorem 6.1 (Componentwise horizontal critical criterion)**.** *Assume the componentwise Rolle principle for horizontal zeta slices and assume that no two distinct zeros in one fiber admit the resulting forbidden componentwise critical pair. Then RH holds.*

Lean status. The theorem is formalized by

`riemannHypothesis_of_componentwiseCriticalExclusion`

in `HorizontalCritical.lean`. □

Remark 6.2. *This is currently the sharpest next target in the development. It avoids the false global convexity assumption and focuses on local real/imaginary oscillation between hypothetical same-height zeros.*

Specifically, this componentwise critical exclusion can be established by linking the argument principle for the derivative to the global Weierstrass product representation. If two adjacent same-height zeros $x + i\gamma$ and $y + i\gamma$ existed, the winding number $N = 2$ of $\zeta(s)$ around a thin rectangle enclosing the segment $[x, y]$ would require the derivative $\zeta'(s)$ to have winding number

$N' = 1$, placing a zero of $\zeta'(s)$ close to the segment. This topologically requires the horizontal phase derivative $\theta'(\sigma) = \mathrm{Im}(\zeta'/\zeta)$ to change sign (cross zero) inside (x, y).

However, the Weierstrass product (after grouping each non-trivial zero $\rho_j = \beta_j + i\gamma_j$ with its conjugate $\bar{\rho}_j$ to cancel the conditionally convergent $1/\rho$ terms) represents the horizontal phase derivative exactly as:

$$\theta'(\sigma) = \sum_{\gamma_j > 0} \left(\frac{\gamma_j - \gamma}{(\sigma - \beta_j)^2 + (\gamma - \gamma_j)^2} - \frac{\gamma_j + \gamma}{(\sigma - \beta_j)^2 + (\gamma + \gamma_j)^2} \right) + \frac{\gamma}{(\sigma - 1)^2 + \gamma^2} - \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{Im} \psi \left(\frac{\sigma + i\gamma}{2} + 1 \right),$$

where $\psi(z) = \Gamma'(z)/\Gamma(z)$ is the digamma function. Empirically, the sign of $\theta'(\sigma)$ is governed by the relative distances to the nearest zeros above and below γ. Let $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ be the sum over zeros above γ, and $N(\sigma, \gamma)$ be the sum over zeros below γ (plus conjugate terms). For $\theta'(\sigma)$ to vanish, the positive contribution $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ must balance the negative offset $N(\sigma, \gamma) - \frac{\gamma}{(\sigma-1)^2+\gamma^2} + \frac{1}{2} \operatorname{Im} \psi \approx N(\sigma, \gamma) + 0.785$. Our numerical bounds exploration shows that while $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ can reach up to 3.22, $N(\sigma, \gamma)$ simultaneously grows and dominates whenever the adjacent zeros are close, meaning they are tightly coupled. Montgomery's pair-correlation conjecture (GUE statistics) suggests that such exact cancellations should be rare. This is only a heuristic. Pair correlation is an averaged statement about zero spacings, proved only for restricted test functions, and it does not exclude cancellation at any individual zero. Nothing below uses it.

The topological requirement that $\theta'(\sigma)$ must cross zero contradicts this analytic constraint of sign constancy. Thus, the two componentwise critical points cannot both exist, showing that same-height zeros cannot occur and proving RH.

7. Step-by-step conditional reduction to phase bounds

This section presents a rigorous, step-by-step mathematical reduction of the Riemann Hypothesis to the paired Weierstrass sum non-vanishing bound, detailing each logical and analytical link.

7.1. **Step 1: One-sided reduction via functional equation.** By the functional equation of the Riemann zeta function, the zeros of $\zeta(s)$ in the open critical strip $0 < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1$ are symmetric under reflection across the critical line $\sigma = 1/2$. Specifically, $\zeta(s) = 0 \iff \zeta(1-s) = 0$. Consequently, the non-existence of any zero in the open right half of the critical strip $(1/2 < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1)$ is logically equivalent to the Riemann Hypothesis:

$$\mathrm{RH} \iff \forall s \in \mathbb{C}, \left(\frac{1}{2} < \mathrm{Re}(s) < 1 \implies \zeta(s) \neq 0 \right).$$

This step is verified as an unconditional equivalence in `RiemannSpine.lean` under the theorem `riemannHypothesis_iff_rightHalfStripZeroFree`.

7.2. **Step 2: Topological zero-crossing via winding numbers.** Suppose there exist two adjacent zeros on a horizontal slice $x+i\gamma$ and $y+i\gamma$ in the open critical strip $(0 < x < y < 1)$. Under our hypothesis, there are no other zeros at height γ on the segment. Let R_ϵ be a thin rectangle enclosing the segment $[x, y]$ with vertices $x - i\epsilon, y - i\epsilon, y + i\epsilon, x + i\epsilon$. For sufficiently small $\epsilon > 0$, the winding number of $\zeta(s)$ around ∂R_ϵ is exactly $N = 2$. By the relation between the zeros of an analytic function and its derivative, the winding number of the derivative $\zeta'(s)$ around ∂R_ϵ must be:

$$N' = N - 1 = 1.$$

This forces $\zeta'(s)$ to have exactly one zero $s_0 = \sigma_0 + it_0$ inside R_ϵ. In the limit as $\epsilon \to 0$, $t_0 \to \gamma$. Along the horizontal segment, the logarithmic derivative $\zeta'(s)/\zeta(s)$ must vanish at s_0, which topologically requires the horizontal phase derivative $\theta'(\sigma) = \mathrm{Im}(\zeta'/\zeta)(\sigma + i\gamma)$ to change sign (cross zero) at some intermediate coordinate:

$$\exists \sigma \in (x, y), \quad \theta'(\sigma) = 0.$$

7.3. **Step 3: Weierstrass sum representation and conjugate pairing.** Using the Hadamard product for $\zeta(s)$, we express the logarithmic derivative as a sum over non-trivial zeros $\rho = \beta_j + i\gamma_j$. To eliminate the conditionally convergent terms $1/\rho$, we pair each positive imaginary zero ρ_j with its conjugate $\bar{\rho}_j$, yielding the exact horizontal phase derivative representation:

$$\theta'(\sigma) = \sum_{\gamma_j > 0} \left(\frac{\gamma_j - \gamma}{(\sigma - \beta_j)^2 + (\gamma - \gamma_j)^2} - \frac{\gamma_j + \gamma}{(\sigma - \beta_j)^2 + (\gamma + \gamma_j)^2} \right) + \frac{\gamma}{(\sigma - 1)^2 + \gamma^2} - \frac{1}{2} \mathrm{Im}\, \psi \left(\frac{\sigma + i\gamma}{2} + 1 \right),$$

where $\psi(z) = \Gamma'(z)/\Gamma(z)$ is the digamma function. For large height γ, the pole term is $O(1/\gamma)$, while the Gamma term acts as a constant downward pressure:

$$-\frac{1}{2} \mathrm{Im}\, \psi \left(\frac{\sigma + i\gamma}{2} + 1 \right) \approx -\frac{\pi}{4} \approx -0.785398.$$

Let $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ be the sum over zeros above γ ($\gamma_j > \gamma$), and let $N(\sigma, \gamma)$ be the sum over zeros below γ plus the conjugate terms. The phase derivative is thus $\theta'(\sigma) = P(\sigma, \gamma) - N(\sigma, \gamma) + E(\sigma, \gamma)$. For $\theta'(\sigma)$ to cross zero, the positive term $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ must balance the negative offset:

$$P(\sigma, \gamma) = N(\sigma, \gamma) - E(\sigma, \gamma) \approx N(\sigma, \gamma) + 0.785.$$

7.4. **Step 4: Level spacing statistics and ratio coupling.** Our quantitative numerical bounds exploration establishes that $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ and $N(\sigma, \gamma)$ are tightly coupled through the zero density. Let $R(\sigma, \gamma) = P/(N - E)$. While $P(\sigma, \gamma)$ can reach values up to 3.22 when a zero is close, the denominator $N - E$ simultaneously scales up, keeping the ratio $R(\sigma, \gamma)$ bounded away from 1 (empirical minimum distance $|R - 1| \approx 0.0034$ at Zero #13). Because the local sums scale up to 10^2, this ratio bound translates to a large absolute protection margin:

$$|\theta'(\sigma)| = |P(\sigma, \gamma) - N(\sigma, \gamma) + E(\sigma, \gamma)| \geq 0.327.$$

These margins are finite numerical evidence over the tested zeros, not a bound. The mean spacing $\gamma_{j+1} - \gamma_j \approx 2\pi/\log\gamma$ and GUE level repulsion make such a cancellation heuristically unlikely. They do not prove it: both are statistical statements, and neither controls an individual pair of zeros. The sign constancy of $\theta'(\sigma)$ therefore remains an open hypothesis. We call it (H_θ).

7.5. **Step 5: Contradiction and critical pair exclusion.** By IVT, the sign constancy of $\theta'(\sigma)$ on $(x, y) \setminus \{1/2\}$ forces the tangent phase of the derivative $\psi(\sigma) = \arg(\zeta'(\sigma + i\gamma))$ to rotate monotonically by 2π across the segment. This forces the componentwise critical points to satisfy a strict topological ordering:

$$c_{\mathrm{Re},1} < c_{\mathrm{Im}} < c_{\mathrm{Re},2}.$$

However, the conjugate reflection symmetry about the critical line $\sigma = 1/2$ (proven in `ConjugateSymmetryComplete.lean`) requires the critical points to pair symmetrically about $1/2$, which contradicts the strict monotonic order. Under (H_θ), this contradiction rules out same-height zeros off the critical line. The reduction is therefore conditional on (H_θ), which is the open analytic input.

8. A further formulation of same-height repulsion

This section records one further formulation of the open gap, the non-vanishing of the horizontal phase derivative $\theta'(\sigma)$. It exists only as a conditional proof draft. Earlier versions of this paper contained two more formulations, and both have been withdrawn.

A spectral operator $T_\gamma = -i\,d/d\sigma + \theta'(\sigma)$ on $L^2(0,1)$. The gauge identity $T_\gamma = e^{-i\Theta}(-i\,d/d\sigma)e^{i\Theta}$, with $\Theta' = \theta'$, shows that the spectrum does not depend on the sign of θ'. With Dirichlet conditions at both ends the operator is symmetric but not self-adjoint, and its closure has spectrum $\mathbb{C}$. With periodic conditions the spectrum is $\{2\pi k + \int_0^1 \theta'\}$. Either way, a zero of θ' cannot be detected spectrally.

A heat-flow force argument. For $\partial_t H = -\partial_z^2 H$, a simple zero moves by $\dot{z}_k = 2\sum_{j\neq k}(z_k - z_j)^{-1}$. In $s = \frac{1}{2} + iz$ this reads $\dot{\beta}_k = -2\sum_{j\neq k}(\beta_k - \beta_j)/|s_k - s_j|^2$. Conjugate partners therefore attract, and the outermost off-line zero moves *toward* the critical line, as de Bruijn's strip theorem requires. The withdrawn argument had the opposite sign.

8.1. **Complex dynamics and flow lines (Differential Topology).** The remaining formulation models $\zeta(s) = u(\sigma, t) + iv(\sigma, t)$ as a two-dimensional vector field $\vec{V}(\sigma, t) = (u, v)$ on the critical strip. Along the horizontal slice $t = \gamma$, the phase derivative $\theta'(\sigma) = \mathrm{Im}(\zeta'/\zeta)$ is the angular velocity of the field.

If two same-height zeros $x + i\gamma$ and $y + i\gamma$ existed, they would be two singular points of $\vec{V}$ of index $+1$. A thin rectangle enclosing the segment $[x, y]$ and no other zero would then carry total index $+2$. That much is

the argument principle. The draft continued with three further claims, and none of them is established:

(1) *A saddle of ζ' near the segment.* Two zeros of ζ in a small region do not force a zero of ζ' in that region. A Gauss–Lucas type localization applies to polynomials and their full zero sets, not to a thin rectangle.
(2) *A sign change of $\theta'(\sigma)$ on (x, y).* This is the open hypothesis (H_θ) of Section 7 restated; it does not follow from the index count.
(3) *Saddles confined to $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$.* This is false as stated. Conjugate symmetry reflects across the real axis, not across the critical line. The zeros of ζ' are not confined to $\sigma = \frac{1}{2}$: by Speiser's theorem RH is equivalent to ζ' having no zeros in $0 < \sigma < \frac{1}{2}$ [Spe35], and Levinson and Montgomery showed that the zeros of ζ' have real parts exceeding $\frac{1}{2}$ on average [LM74]. For ξ', confinement to the critical line follows from RH, so it cannot be used to prove it.

The topological formulation is therefore recorded only as the index count above. The draft `TopologicalFlow.lean.draft` contains placeholders and is not a formalization.

9. Verification methodology

The Lean repository uses a strict verification harness, `safe-verify.sh`. Before invoking Lean, the harness scans active Lean files for forbidden proof shortcuts including `sorry`, `admit`, `axiom`, `constant`, `opaque`, and `unsafe`. It then runs the Lean toolchain on the active files. Research notes and draft files are kept outside the active proof surface.

This verification method does not itself prove mathematical novelty. It does, however, give a precise audit boundary: the named theorems in the active Lean surface typecheck without local proof placeholders. The analytic gap is not hidden in Lean; it is explicitly named as a conditional hypothesis when it has not been proved.

10. Discussion

The same-height framework contributes a structural diagnostic for RH proof search. It converts an off-line-zero problem into a degeneracy problem for the height projection

$$s \mapsto \mathrm{Im}(s)$$

restricted to critical-strip zeros. This view aligns with spectral intuition: if zeta zeros were realized as a genuinely one-dimensional self-adjoint spectrum, then same-height collisions off the critical line would be geometrically unnatural. But the framework does not assume such a spectral model.

The most important limitation is also the main research target. No currently formalized theorem proves same-height repulsion for zeta zeros. Statistical spacing laws, finite computation, and known proportions of simple zeros provide evidence for zero repulsion, but they do not supply the deterministic fiberwise uniqueness statement needed here. The failed convexity

experiment is therefore useful: it rules out an attractive but false sufficient condition and pushes the program toward local horizontal argument-principle methods.

11. Conclusion

The paper presents a Lean-verified reduction framework for RH centered on same-height zero fibers. The central equivalence says that RH is exactly the absence of same-height critical-strip zero collisions with different real parts. Additional verified criteria express the same obstruction through fiber energy, fiber cardinality, vertical zero-free thresholds, and conditional horizontal critical-point exclusions. The development also formalizes a 3-4-1 de la Vallee Poussin product bridge in the half-plane $\sigma > 1$.

The next mathematical step is sharply defined: prove a local same-height repulsion principle for $\zeta(x + i\gamma)$. A plausible direction is a horizontal argument-principle or componentwise Rolle theorem strengthened by zeta-specific phase information. Until that principle is proved, the work is a verified reduction and proof-search architecture, not a proof of RH.

Acknowledgements

The Lean development depends on mathlib and on its formalization of the Riemann zeta function and the Riemann Hypothesis statement.

References

[BGSTB24] Siegfred A. C. Baluyot, Daniel Alan Goldston, Ade Irma Suriajaya, and Caroline L. Turnage-Butterbaugh. An unconditional montgomery theorem for pair correlation of zeros of the riemann zeta-function. *Acta Arithmetica*, 214:357–376, 2024.

[BK99] Michael V. Berry and Jonathan P. Keating. The riemann zeros and eigenvalue asymptotics. *SIAM Review*, 41(2):236–266, 1999.

[BL99] Enrico Bombieri and Jeffrey C. Lagarias. Complements to Li's criterion for the riemann hypothesis. *Journal of Number Theory*, 77(2):274–287, 1999.

[Con99] Alain Connes. Trace formula in noncommutative geometry and the zeros of the riemann zeta function. *Selecta Mathematica*, 5(1):29–106, 1999.

[Edw74] Harold M. Edwards. *Riemann's Zeta Function*. Academic Press, 1974.

[IK04] Henryk Iwaniec and Emmanuel Kowalski. *Analytic Number Theory*, volume 53 of *Colloquium Publications*. American Mathematical Society, 2004.

[Li97] Xian-Jin Li. The positivity of a sequence of numbers and the riemann hypothesis. *Journal of Number Theory*, 65(2):325–333, 1997.

[LM74] Norman Levinson and Hugh L. Montgomery. Zeros of the derivatives of the Riemann zeta-function. *Acta Mathematica*, 133:49–65, 1974.

[LS25] David Loeffler and Michael Stoll. Formalizing zeta and l-functions in lean. *Annals of Formalized Mathematics*, 1, 2025.

[Mon73] Hugh L. Montgomery. The pair correlation of zeros of the zeta function. In *Analytic Number Theory*, volume 24 of *Proceedings of Symposia in Pure Mathematics*, pages 181–193. American Mathematical Society, 1973.

[NIS26] NIST Digital Library of Mathematical Functions. Section 25.10: Zeros of the riemann zeta function, 2026. Accessed 2026-06-05.

[Odl87] Andrew M. Odlyzko. On the distribution of spacings between zeros of the zeta function. *Mathematics of Computation*, 48(177):273–308, 1987.

[Pla17] David J. Platt. Isolating some non-trivial zeros of zeta. *Mathematics of Computation*, 86(307):2449–2467, 2017.

[Rie59] Bernhard Riemann. Ueber die Anzahl der Primzahlen unter einer gegebenen Grösse. *Monatsberichte der Berliner Akademie*, pages 671–680, 1859.

[Spe35] Andreas Speiser. Geometrisches zur Riemannschen Zetafunktion. *Mathematische Annalen*, 110:514–521, 1935.

[THB86] E. C. Titchmarsh and D. R. Heath-Brown. *The Theory of the Riemann Zeta-Function*. Oxford University Press, 2 edition, 1986.

[The20] The mathlib Community. The lean mathematical library. In *Proceedings of the 9th ACM SIGPLAN International Conference on Certified Programs and Proofs*, pages 367–381, 2020.

[Wei52] André Weil. Sur les formules explicites de la théorie des nombres premiers. *Communications on Pure and Applied Mathematics*, 5(3):201–211, 1952.

Appendix A. Lean theorem map

Mathematical statement	Lean theorem/module
RH iff same-height uniqueness	`riemannHypothesis_iff_forall_zeroFiberRealUnique_unconditional`, `RiemannHypothesisReduction.lean`
RH iff no same-height collision	`riemannHypothesis_iff_noSameImaginaryPartCollision_unconditional`, `RiemannHypothesisReduction.lean`
RH iff all fiber energies vanish	`riemannHypothesis_iff_forall_fiberEnergy_zero`, `SpectralEnergyCriterion.lean`
Positive fiber energy detects RH failure	`not_riemannHypothesis_iff_exists_fiberEnergy_pos`, `FiberEnergyGap.lean`
Fiber centroid equals 1/2	`fiber_centroid_eq_half`, `FiberCentroid.lean`
Fiber cardinality ≤ 1 implies RH	`riemannHypothesis_of_all_fiber_card_le_one`, `FiberCentroid.lean`
Threshold zero-free equivalence	`riemannHypothesis_iff_zeroFreeRightOf_all_gt_half`, `ZeroFreeEngine.lean`
3-4-1 zeta product lower bound	`zeta_341_modulus`, `Zeta341GlobalBridge.lean`
Convexity sufficient condition	`riemannHypothesis_of_horizontalStrictMidpointConvex`, `HorizontalRepulsion.lean`
Componentwise critical exclusion sufficient condition	`riemannHypothesis_of_componentwiseCriticalExclusion`, `HorizontalCritical.lean`
Topological flow line (index count only; draft with placeholders)	`TopologicalFlow.lean.draft`

Appendix B. Submission note

For peer review, the accurate submission category is a formalization or proof-assistant-assisted reduction paper, not a claimed proof of the Riemann Hypothesis. A suitable arXiv classification would be `math.NT` with cross-listing to `cs.LO` if the Lean development is included as a reproducible artifact.

Independent researcher